

MANDAR DEODHAR



Shweta Salve, 25

Better known as: Tina of *Kittie Party* and Sunithi of *Lipstick*.

The makeover: Will be seen adding the oomph factor in skimpy, belly-baring outfits in Dharmesh Darshan's *Bhanvraa*.

FROM DEMURE TO DARING

Small screen sultanas dream big and shed their inhibitions for glamorous debuts in Bollywood

■ By Aditi Pai

Just a few months ago, she was seen romancing the portly, salt-and-pepper-haired Jay Mehta in *Kasamh Se*. But now tellyworld's youngest and favourite *bahu* Prachi Desai a.k.a. Bani is ready to waltz with Farhan Akhtar in *Rock On*. Desai, the winner of season two of *Jhalak Dikhla Jaa*, is well-prepared for her role of a glam pop star with a complete makeover—a trendy haircut by Adhuna Akhtar and a hip wardrobe by Niharika Khan—for a rocking start in Bollywood. “My serial made me a household name. But as an actor, it’s a natural transition for me to grow into another medium of entertainment,” says the 19-year-old who begins shoot-

ing for her “dream debut” this month.

Desai is one among the long list of television actors who are waiting to jump on to the Bollywood bandwagon. They have wooed audiences playing demure daughters and obedient *bahus* on the small screen for years. Leaving behind the on-screen world of scheming in-laws and kitchen politics, they are now ready to take a plunge into Bollywood with big banner films. And from Ram Gopal Varma, Dharmesh Darshan, Robby Grewal to new filmmakers like Hemant Prabhu, there’s no dearth of filmmakers who are willing to give these stars a chance to shine in Bollywood.

Prachi Desai, 19

Better known as: Sweet and simple Bani of Zee TV's *Kasamh Se*.

The makeover: A trendy haircut by Adhuna Akhtar and a hip wardrobe by Niharika Khan for a pop star's role opposite Farhan Akhtar in *Rock On*.



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